

Chapter 108-2

//

Xu Qingzhu wasn't really much better than Liang Shi when it came to comforting people.

Especially when facing Liang Wanwan, whom she wasn't familiar with at all.

To her, Liang Wanwan was a stranger.

She had only met Liang Wanwan twice in total—once at her wedding to Liang Shi, and once when she went back to the old residence with Liang Shi.

Her impression of Liang Wanwan could be summed up in two words: quiet.

She and the former Liang Shi seemed like two extremes—one flitting among flowers and playing around in the world, the other being a quiet, well-behaved girl who had nothing to do with such matters.

So back then, everyone said that Qiu Zimin really knew how to raise children.

And Qiu Zimin knew precisely what all the moral standards were.

All her indulgence of Liang Shi was kept beneath the moral baseline.

She simply wanted to ruin Liang Shi, nothing more.

Xu Qingzhu was usually a rather quiet person herself. Now that she had been pushed out by Liang Shi to handle these matters, although she had no method to her approach, she could only steel herself and do it.

In front of Liang Wanwan, she could barely be considered an elder, so she initiated small talk: "Are you okay?"

Liang Wanwan first nodded, then slowly shook her head and called out aggrievedly, "Sister Qingzhu."

Liang Wanwan had a pure and innocent appearance. Without makeup, her fair face was full of collagen, and her eyes were red. She looked like a pitiful little white rabbit. Xu Qingzhu hurriedly handed her tissues and comforted her in a low voice: "Don't cry first. Your eyes are all red from crying."

Xu Qingzhu's only experience with comforting someone was with five-year-old Ling Dang.

In her family, Xu Qingya had an outgoing personality and had been carefree since childhood. And because she had been kidnapped when she was young, she had always stayed at home and never went out to school. From a young age, Xu Qingya had been taught to yield to her older sister and protect her.

Although she also wanted to be a good older sister, she never had the opportunity.

Xu Qingya was too strong, which only made her seem weak in comparison.

Besides, with Xu Qingya's personality, she didn't need comforting at all—you just needed to hand her tools when she wanted to go fight.

So when Xu Qingzhu was comforting Liang Wanwan now, it was a bit like coaxing a child, and even her voice unconsciously became more childlike.

Liang Wanwan was also immersed in her own world of sadness and didn't notice.

But Liang Shi, who was making ginger sugar water in the kitchen, heard it. She inexplicably rubbed her ears, the corners of her mouth curving upward.

Liang Shi tied up her hair with the hair tie she had taken from Xu Qingzhu's wrist. Misty steam drifted through the kitchen, and the small space was filled with the sweet smell of sugar.

Liang Shi thought it didn't smell as nice as the scent on Xu Qingzhu.

Meanwhile, Xu Qingzhu was sitting in the living room feeling rather at ease.

She didn't feel like she absolutely had to do something just because Liang Wanwan was crying.

On the contrary, when Liang Wanwan cried, she just handed her tissues from the side and kicked the living room trash can over to Liang Wanwan's feet.

Liang Wanwan was usually accustomed to being quiet, so even her crying was very quiet.

It didn't make Xu Qingzhu feel troubled or emotionally drained.

When Liang Wanwan had cried until she was tired, until she had cried enough, she finally threw a large wad of tissues into the trash can. Then she let out a soft breath and said guiltily to Xu Qingzhu: "I'm sorry, Sister Qingzhu."

"It's nothing," Xu Qingzhu said. "Your sister went to make ginger sugar water. If you don't want to talk to me, you can wait for her to come out and then tell her."

It was like kicking the ball, passing this matter back to Liang Shi again.

But Liang Wanwan said, "That's not it. It's not that I don't want to talk to you."

Xu Qingzhu: "Hm?"

"I... I just don't know how to say it." Liang Wanwan sniffled, wanting to cry again but forcibly holding it back. She apologized again: "I'm sorry for causing you trouble."

"It's not a big deal." Xu Qingzhu's tone was a bit like Sally's when she had just learned Mandarin—relaxed, trying to make Liang Wanwan not mind.

After a pause, Xu Qingzhu added: "This is your sister's home. If you've been wronged, just come here. Isn't that what older sisters are for?"

Liang Wanwan looked at her, her eyes glistening with tears.

Facing such a gaze from her, Xu Qingzhu felt quite pressured psychologically and flickered her eyes away.

Liang Wanwan thought for a moment before saying: "Sister Qingzhu, I'm a little scared."

"Scared of what?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Wanwan let out a heavy breath and was about to speak when Liang Shi walked out of the kitchen. She placed a cup filled with ginger sugar water in front of Liang Wanwan. There was even a purple straw in the cup—quite thoughtful.

Xu Qingzhu glanced over, and Liang Shi quickly brought over another cup, placing it in front of her.

Liang Shi said: "Drink the ginger sugar water first. Warm yourself up."

Liang Wanwan thanked her quietly, "Thank you, Jie."

Liang Shi went to the kitchen to put away the tray. Hearing her thanks, she said it was nothing.

After Liang Shi returned to the living room, Liang Wanwan finally talked about what happened that evening. Even after finishing, she was still so angry that her hands were shaking. "Why did she touch my clothes?! Even the servants at home don't touch them."

"Where did you put Chen Mian's sketchbook?" Liang Shi asked. "Is there any way to restore it?"

Liang Wanwan shook her head. "It's all soaked through. Completely ruined."

Water had seeped into the plastic-sealed packaging, getting everything wet. After going through the washing machine, it had almost all turned into shredded paper scraps. It was impossible to look at anymore.

However, Liang Wanwan had still kept it. She put it in her wallet.

Now she gently spread it out flat, but you couldn't tell what it had originally looked like at all.